Unit 8 — Civic English: Rights and Voices

Track G+M · Klasse 10 · Niveau G/M

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a short civic text and identify a stated right and a stated duty.*
- *I can use be entitled to*, *be required to*, *be expected to* in formal contexts.
- *I can hold a 3-minute civic-question conversation in formal English.*

Lead-in I

Maja's class read a one-page summary of the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child. They argued for twenty minutes about Article 12 — *every child has the right to be heard in matters affecting them.* Half the class said *that's already true*. The other half said *that's poorly enforced.* Mr. Yilmaz said: *both can be true*.

Vocabulary I

- right
- duty
- obligation
- citizen
- resident
- constitution
- convention
- treaty
- ratify
- enforce
- entitled to
- required to

Vocabulary I

- expected to
- consult
- represent
- advocate
- petition
- due process

Reading I

Reading — *Article 12, paraphrased*
Every child has the right to express an opinion in matters affecting them, and that opinion is to be given due weight in accordance with the child's age and maturity. This right does not mean that children decide; it means that adults are required to listen and to consider. The article is one of the most frequently cited and one of the most unevenly enforced in the convention.

Vocabulary — civic English
right, duty, obligation, citizen, resident, constitution, convention, treaty, ratify, enforce, entitled to, required to, expected to, consult, represent, advocate, petition, due process.

Grammar — formal entitlement / duty phrases

Reading II

- *Children **are entitled to** express their views.*
- *Adults **are required to** consider those views.*
- *Schools **are expected to** consult students on rules that affect them.*
- Negative: ***are not obliged to*** **decide based on those views.**

Practise I

Niveau G

1. Choose: *entitled / required / expected* — Children are _____ to express their views. Adults are _____ to listen.
2. Match: right → entitlement; duty → obligation; ratify → formally accept.

Niveau M

3. Build 4 civic-English sentences using *entitled / required / expected* about a school or local civic topic.

Your turn I

Pair speaking — *Article 12 in our school*. 3 min each direction. Question: *How is the right to be heard handled in our school?* Use 4 formal civic phrases + 1 cautious-claim phrase.

Sample

— Students are entitled to express their views on rules that affect them. In our school, this is partly handled through the student representatives. According to the head pupil, however, only some rules are actually consulted on. It appears that the system works best for visible issues like break-time use, and less well for less visible ones like marking practice. Adults are required to consider student views, but they are not obliged to act on them.

Reflect I

- I can identify a right and a duty in a civic text.
- I can use formal entitlement / duty phrases.
- I can hold a 3-minute civic-question conversation in formal English.

Further reading / listening I

- UNICEF — child-friendly version of the CRC.
- Council of Europe — accessible articles on Convention rights.